

MICROPOLIS

THE CITY SIMULATOR



8-BIT CITY SIMULATION
BATTERY CITY SAVE

MPLS-01

THE JOB

Congratulations, Mayor. The land is green, the treasury is full, and absolutely nothing works yet. Zone neighborhoods, wire them to a power plant, connect them by road, and keep the budget out of the red. The city that grows from there is up to you.

CONTROLS

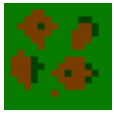
D-PAD	Move the cursor. Hold to glide. Push past the screen edge to scroll the map.
A	Use the current tool at the cursor.
B	Open / close the build menu.
SELECT	Quick-cycle to the next tool.
START	City report: budget, tax rate, sim speed, disasters.

YOUR FIRST TEN MINUTES

1. On the title screen pick NEW CITY and a difficulty - that is your starting treasury (\$20,000 / \$10,000 / \$5,000).
2. Build a COAL POWER plant on open land (\$3,000).
3. Zone a few RESIDENTIAL plots nearby (\$100 each).
4. Run a POWER LINE from the plant to the first zone. Zones that touch each other pass power along, so one line can feed a whole district.
5. Lay a ROAD within two tiles of every zone.
6. Wait. Houses appear, the population climbs, and commerce and industry start asking for zones of their own - watch the R C I bars in the status bar.

IF A ZONE FLASHES A LIGHTNING BOLT

It has no electricity. Trace your power lines: every zone needs an unbroken path of wires (or touching zones) back to a plant.



BULLDOZER

\$1

Clears any tile. Levels whole zones. Cannot stop fire.



ROAD

\$10

Zones need one within 2 tiles. Yearly upkeep.



POWER LINE

\$5

Carries power. Place on a river for a pylon crossing.



RAIL

\$20

Heavy transit. Crosses rivers as a trestle bridge.



PARK

\$10

Green space. The neighbors approve.



RESIDENTIAL

\$100

Homes. Grows when powered, roaded, and jobs exist.



COMMERCIAL

\$100

Shops and offices. Feeds on a growing population.



INDUSTRIAL

\$100

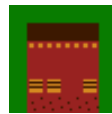
Factories. Your early economic engine.



POLICE DEPT

\$500 +\$100/yr

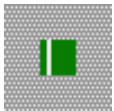
Keeps crime down as the city grows.



FIRE DEPT

\$500 +\$100/yr

Fires burn out faster with coverage.



STADIUM

\$5,000

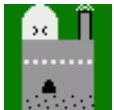
Residential demands one for top density.



COAL POWER

\$3,000

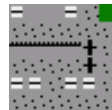
Reliable power. Not pretty.



NUKE POWER

\$5,000

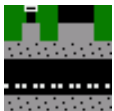
More power. Ask about our meltdown policy.



SEAPORT

\$3,000

Industry demands one for top density.



AIRPORT

\$10,000

Commerce demands one for top density.

CROSSING WATER

Rivers are not the end of the line. Place the POWER LINE or RAIL tool directly on water to build a crossing. Straight spans only - and bulldozing one gives the river back.



GROWTH

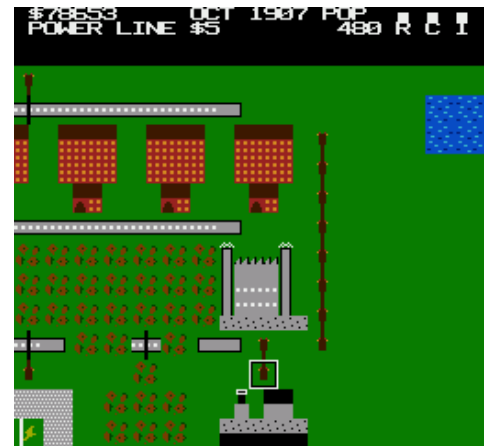
Zones develop through four stages, from empty plot to a full city block, driven by the R C I demand bars: residents come for jobs, commerce and industry come for residents. Every zone must be powered and near a road. Top density needs the big amenities - a Stadium for residents, a Seaport for industry, an Airport for commerce. The advisor line in the status bar tells you what the city wants next.

MONEY & TIME

Taxes are collected every January: population times tax rate. Roads, rails and stations charge their upkeep at the same time. Press START for the city report, where you set the tax rate (high taxes scare off growth), the simulation speed, and whether disasters strike. Your approval rating lives there too.

DISASTERS

Fires spread through trees and buildings - fire stations shorten them, firebreaks stop them. Tornadoes carve tracks of rubble. Nuclear plants are perfectly safe, except when they are not. Pictured: a tornado leveled this city's commercial district, which blacked out the seaport. Too exciting? Turn disasters OFF in the city report.



SAVING

The cartridge battery saves your city automatically every January and whenever you open the city report. Pick CONTINUE on the title screen to pick up where you left off.

MAYOR'S FIELD NOTES

- Zones conduct power to each other. Wire districts, not tiles.
- Industry bootstraps fastest; residential follows jobs.
- 7% tax is the citizens' comfort zone. Raise it at your peril.
- Nothing on fire? Nothing next to fire? You are doing fine.